The pxSRC package

Safe inclusion of referenced sources for LaTeX2e

Scvria
P3CTeX / UOC PEC Repository

2026/02/26 – Version 0.2

Abstract

pxSRC provides a small LaTeX2e API to include figures robustly. When an image file is missing, a consistent placeholder is rendered instead of raising a compilation error. This is intended for PEC workflows where some assets may be produced later but the document must remain buildable.

Contents

1 Loading the package

```
\usepackage{pxSRC}
```

2 Configuration (keys)

pxSRC provides a small key family pxSRC to tune defaults. Set keys with:

```
\pxSRCsetup{<key>=<value>,...}
```

Available keys (defaults shown):

- default-width (default .8\linewidth)
- pair-width (default .4\linewidth)
- placeholder-color (default gray)
- float-spec (default H)
- pair-gap (default 4em)
- label-prefix (default img:)

3 User command reference

3.1 Single image

\pxIMG

Safely includes an image (or a placeholder if not found) in a `figure` environment.

```
\pxIMG[<width>]{<image>}[<placeholder-color>]{<caption>}[<short/label>]
```

The `<image>` argument may be provided without extension; `pxSRC` tries common extensions (`.png`, `.pdf`, `.jpg`) when resolving the file.

If the last optional argument is omitted, `pxSRC` auto-generates a safe `\label` from the image name (sanitising path separators), prefixed by `label-prefix` (default `img:`).

3.2 Image pair

\pxIMGpair

Safely includes two images side-by-side. Each missing file becomes a placeholder, independently.

```
\pxIMGpair[<width>]{<left-image>}{<right-image>}[<placeholder-color>]{<caption>}[<sh
```

3.3 Sequential image list

\pxIMGList

Includes a list of consecutively numbered images whose filenames follow the pattern `<base><n>` (e.g. `plot1`, `plot2`, ...), using one caption per item.

```
\pxIMGList[<path-prefix>]{<base>}[<caption-prefix>]{cap1,cap2,cap3}
```

Example:

```
\pxIMGList[img/]{iter}{Step: }{one,two,three}
```

4 Minimal example

```
\usepackage{pxSRC}
\begin{document}
\pxSRCsetup{placeholder-color=blue,float-spec=htbp}
\pxIMG[.6\linewidth]{img/diagram}[blue]{System diagram}[fig:system]
\pxIMGpair{img/a}{img/b}[gray]{Comparison}[fig:pair]
\pxIMGList[img/]{run}{Iteration: }{first,second,third}
\end{document}
```